



THURSDAY

MARCH 13, 2025
RAMADAN 13, 1446

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Rents in Dubai show signs of stabilising

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Dubai's residential rental market may be cooling, with increased inventory offering tenants more options and potentially slowing rent hikes in some areas.

According to brokerage firm Betterhomes, more homes are hitting the market, which is contributing to rent stabilisation in 2025, especially in mid-market areas like Discovery Gardens, Sports City, and Deira.

Tenants, who have faced steep rent increases of 20 per cent to 40 per cent over the past three years, are now becoming more price-sensitive, while landlords who adjust their rates can secure tenants more quickly.

Rental index effect

The new Dubai Rental Index, launched two months ago, is also influencing rent trends, tracking real-time market data and introducing a star rating system for buildings. Experts believe it will take a few months for the market to fully absorb these changes. Despite signs of a slight slowdown in rent growth, experts stress that this is part of a healthy market cycle, not a correction.

SEE ALSO P5

Pakistani army frees hostages, kills all militants in train siege

346 HOSTAGES FREED; 28 SOLDIERS AND OVER 30 MILITANTS KILLED IN STANDOFF

SIBI, PAKISTAN

Pakistani security forces killed all militants in an exchange of gunfire with the insurgents who have been holding a train and its passengers hostage since Tuesday in southwestern Balochistan province.

All the train passengers taken hostage by the militants have been freed, an army official told AFP yesterday, adding that 28 soldiers were killed in the siege.

"346 hostages were freed and over 30 terrorists were killed during the operation," the army official told AFP, adding that 27 off-duty soldiers who were passengers on the train were killed by militants, and one soldier killed during the operation.

Trading fire

Authorities traded fire with the militants during the rescue efforts, the officials said, adding that 17 people were injured. The outlawed Balochistan Liberation Army (BLA) took responsibility for the attack according to Pakistani media.

The operation took time as security forces faced militants wearing suicide vests and standing close to the passengers, said the officials.

Militants from separatist groups like BLA have been attacking security forces in min-



AFP

■ Paramedics treat an injured passenger at the Mach railway station, which was turned into a makeshift hospital, after armed militants ambushed a train in southwestern Balochistan.

eral-rich Balochistan, which borders Afghanistan, for decades but the frequency has increased in the past few years.

Imtiaz Gul, executive director of the Islamabad-based Center for Research and Security Studies, said seizing a passenger train appears to be a new strategy for the BLA, which has also previously hit infrastruc-

ture. "This is a tactic to terrorise both common people and security apparatus," Gul said. "They have scaled the ladder."

The attack comes as Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif tries to rebuild an anaemic economy and lure investment, while struggling to control violence from militants.

Militants had targeted a con-

voy of Chinese workers at Port Qasim Electric Power Co., near Karachi's airport last year. Two Chinese nationals died in the incident.

China Foreign Ministry spokeswoman Mao Ning strongly condemned the latest attack during a regular press briefing in Beijing yesterday. — Agencies

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